

PORTFOLIO BUILDING: ACTIVITY 13

GLOBAL TECH AMBASSADOR & OPEN-SOURCE PATHWAY SELECTION

STUDENT NAME V. Saardhak Ram	ROLL NUMBER R25EJ171	PROGRAM / SEM B.Tech CSE (Sem 3)	SELECTED TRACKS AI/ML, DevOps, GitHub
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PART A: PROGRAM ANALYSIS & TARGET SELECTION

Feature / Criteria	Program 1: Microsoft Learn Student Ambassador (MLSA)	Program 2: GitHub Campus Experts
Technical Track	AI/ML, Cloud Infrastructure, & Azure DevOps	Open-Source Collaboration, Git, & Campus Leadership
Eligibility Rules	18+ yrs, full-time undergraduate; must complete at least one Microsoft Learn learning path.	Active GitHub user (>6 mos), >12 months remaining until graduation date.
Cycle & Deadlines	Continuous onboarding; applications evaluated quarterly.	Biannual application window (Next targeted cycle: Feb 2027).
Primary Benefits	Azure credits, LinkedIn Learning, Microsoft technical mentorship, global community network.	Public speaking & leadership training, event funding/sponsorship, exclusive swag & gear.

PART B1: READINESS ASSESSMENT & GAP ANALYSIS

Requirement Area	Current Profile Status	Identified Gap & Action Required
GitHub Activity	Basic repository hosting; irregular contribution chart.	Gap: Lacks 6 months of continuous active contribution history. Action: Commit daily, push 2 core repos, submit public PRs.
AI/ML & DevOps Proof	Classroom knowledge in Python, Linux, and ML concepts.	Gap: No deployed CI/CD pipelines or hosted ML model microservices. Action: Complete MS Learn Azure DevOps/AI paths; publish Docker setup.
Community Leadership	Active participant in campus workshops and events.	Gap: Lack of documented experience leading or organizing technical events. Action: Co-organize a hands-on Git & GitHub workshop for peers.

Strategic Alignment Note: 3rd semester is the optimal target window for GitHub Campus Experts and MLSA. Initiating the 4-week preparation timeline now ensures all GitHub activity and technical write-up metrics exceed baseline requirements prior to application deadlines.

PART B2: 4-WEEK ACTION-ORIENTED PREPARATION ROADMAP

- **Week 1: Platform Setup & Learning Paths**
Optimize GitHub profile with a custom profile README .md, pinned repositories, and daily commits. Complete Microsoft Learn modules for *Azure DevOps Fundamentals* and *AI Engineering Principles*.
- **Week 2: Hands-On Project & Technical Content**
Build and deploy a containerized AI model microservice with an automated CI/CD pipeline using GitHub Actions. Publish a step-by-step technical guide on Dev.to detailing the implementation process.
- **Week 3: Campus Community Event Execution**
Partner with college tech clubs to co-host a 90-minute workshop on "Git, GitHub, and DevOps Workflows for Beginners." Gather attendee feedback, photos, and impact metrics for application portfolio validation.
- **Week 4: Video Essay & Application Finalization**
Record a compelling 2-minute video response demonstrating community motivation and technical drive in AI/ML and DevOps. Review metrics and finalize submission entries on the MLSA portal.

PART C: TECHNICAL COMMUNITY MOTIVATION ESSAY

250 WORDS

Technology moves at an unprecedented pace, but its real power is unlocked when knowledge is shared openly within a community. As a 3rd-semester Computer Science student specializing in AI/ML and DevOps, my goal is to bridge the gap between theoretical software development and scalable real-world deployment for my peers. Programs like Microsoft Learn Student Ambassadors and GitHub Campus Experts offer the perfect platform to foster this culture of continuous integration and collaborative learning on campus.

Many early-stage students hesitate to engage with open-source repositories or automated cloud pipelines due to a lack of structured guidance. As a tech ambassador, I aim to demystify these workflows by establishing hands-on workshops focused on version control, CI/CD automation, and accessible AI deployment. By organizing collaborative hackathons and peer mentoring sessions, I want to create an inclusive space where students can confidently build, break, and deploy software together.

Leveraging resources such as Azure cloud credits and GitHub leadership training, I plan to build a thriving student developer community that equips peers with production-ready technical skills before graduation. Joining these global student pathways will allow me to serve as a catalyst for technical growth, empowering my campus community to build impactful open-source projects.